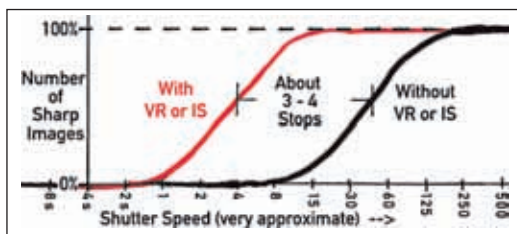


is mostly built into the lens. So effectively they have an array of motion sensors which detect the minute shake in your hand and body while you're shooting,

and then using actuators they tilt/shift some lens elements to counter-act this shake. This cycle is repeated about many times a second. Amazing, isn't it?

As a rule of thumb, you should always use a shutter speed equivalent to the inverse of your focal length. So at 50 mm, you should use a shutter speed of at least 1/50s to get sharp photographs. With optical image stabilisation, you can easily shoot handheld at 1/15s at a focal length of 50mm allowing you to gain almost four times as much light. In typical test, image stabilisation boosts you up by at least 2 full-stops and if you're lucky then up to 4 stops in certain conditions. (Boost by 1 stop means twice the light)

Be aware of marketing gimmicks like Digital Image Stabilisation. All it does is some poor post processing to remove some blur partially from your photographs; stay away from it.



Usefulness of VR

Courtesy: KenRockWell.com

Buying a lens

Given the myriad of options available, buying a lens can turn into a nightmare. To make it easy for you we present a simple list of steps which, if followed, even to an approximation can make your life much simpler. After each step you'd notice that the number of lenses available to you would reduce to half and by Sstep 4 you should have only 3-4 lenses to pick from.

So here we go – six steps to help you find the best digital SLR lens:

1. Determine the focal length you'll need
2. Decide if you want a prime or zoom lens
3. Select a maximum aperture
4. Choose between first or third-party lenses (Hint: always try and fit a first-party lens in your budget, they offer excellent resale value also)
5. Evaluate any extra features
6. Read reviews and narrow your options . 